

Ideation Phase

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Date	28 september 2026
Team ID	SWTID-2026-4908
Project Name	Import Data using Transform Maps
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

* Team Setup & Collaboration Tools:

* Participants: ServiceNow Developer, System Administrator, Data Management Lead.

* Collaboration Platform: Virtual Whiteboard / Mural Canvas for structured idea mapping.

* Context & Problem Background:

Organizations frequently need to migrate or load external employee spreadsheets into ServiceNow. Manually typing each record into the target table is inefficient, error-prone, and cannot handle large datasets.

* Selected Problem Statement:

"How can we automate the ingestion of legacy spreadsheet data into a custom ServiceNow table (Employee Test) using Import Sets and Transform Maps while preventing duplicate records?"

Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

During the brainstorming session, the team explored different approaches for table design, data ingestion, and transformation logic:

Group 1: Target Table Design (Employee Test)

- * Idea 1A: Use the standard out-of-the-box sys_user table (Rejected: Project requires a isolated custom table).

- * Idea 1B: Create a custom table named Employee Test (u_employee_test) with string fields for Employee ID, Employee Name, Email, Department, and Location (Selected).

Group 2: Data Import & Staging Method

- * Idea 2A: Upload spreadsheet (Sample Spreadsheet.xlsx) to create an Import Set staging table (u_employee_import) via System Import Sets > Load Data (Selected).

- * Idea 2B: Programmatically parse Excel files using server scripts (Rejected: Unnecessarily complex for standard imports).

Group 3: Mapping & Duplication Strategy

- * Idea 3A: Manually create individual field maps for every column (Rejected: Time-consuming).

- * Idea 3B: Generate an Employee Transform Map and execute Auto Map Matching Fields to map source columns to target table fields automatically (Selected).

- * Idea 3C: Enable Coalesce on Employee ID (u_employee_id) to update existing records and insert new ones, preventing duplicate records (Selected).

Step-3: Idea Prioritization (Effort vs. Impact Matrix)

Idea Code	Description	Impact	Effort	Prioritization Decision
Idea 1B	Create custom table Employee Test (u_employee_test)	High	Low	Quick Win (Implement)
Idea 2A	Stage data via Import Set table u_employee_import	High	Low	Quick Win (Implement)
Idea 3B	Use Transform Map with Auto Map Matching	High	Low	Quick Win (Implement)
Idea 3C	Enable Coalesce on Employee ID to prevent duplicates	High	Low	Quick Win (Implement)
Idea 2B	Custom Script Ingestion	Low	High	Drop (Too Complex)